Game set-up and timing

Tables of 3 players

- 3 players per table: Feeder, Packer, Compute backend. About 10 people: 3 tables, one observer.
- Per table: red 🟥, green 🟩, blue 🟦 and yellow 🟨 notes; 8 red notes written in advance, `S1` … `S8`
- Per table: pens, scrap paper cut in quarters (the parcels), 3 boards, 3 role sheets, the two cards on the last page
- Pink and yellow pads for the 1-2-4-All

TIME	STEP
3 min	**Explain the game**
5 min	**Read sheets, set up the table**
7 min	**Round 1, happy path**
2 + 7 min	**Reset, round 2, a surprise failure**
2 + 7 min	**Reset, round 3, roles rotate and new packer rule**
7 min	**Debrief**

The table

SIMULATION board

1 red per parcel

Pool	Done	Outputs

RECONSTRUCTION board

2 green per parcel

Pool	Done	Outputs

MERGE board

4 blue per parcel

Pool	Done	Outputs

Seed stack
S1 … S8, written in advance

Backend seat
pads, pens; one parcel at a time

Bin
every used parcel, done or failed. Never reused.

A parcel is a quarter sheet with the input notes stuck on it (`P5 · RECO`). After the job, the Compute backend puts ✓ inputs in Done, new notes in Outputs, ✗ inputs back in their Pool, and the empty parcel in the Bin.

Only the seeds have names, written in advance. The other notes stay blank: green is what Simulation makes, blue Reconstruction, yellow Merge.

Feeder

You play the **feeder** plugin of all three transformations, one board at a time. On Reconstruction and Merge you are an **edge feeder**: your inputs are the outputs of the board before.

You hold: the seed stack S1 … S8. Never more than **2 notes** in your hands.

1. **Simulation:** move seeds 🟥 from the stack into its Pool, **at most 2 at a time**. Stack empty? Say **“Simulation feed is over.”**
2. **Reconstruction**, once Simulation's Done holds all 8 seeds: move the green notes 🟩 from Simulation's Outputs into its Pool, at most 2 at a time. Outputs empty? Say **“Reconstruction feed is over.”**
3. **Merge**, once Reconstruction's Done holds all 8 green notes: the same with the blue notes 🟦. Then say **“Merge feed is over.”**

Packer

You play the **packer** plugin of all three transformations, one board at a time: you decide which notes go together in one job.

You hold: paper quarters, a pen. A rule may change in round 3.

1. Take notes from the Pool of the current board: **Simulation** 1 seed per parcel, **Reconstruction** 2 green, **Merge** 4 blue.
2. Write `P1 · SIM` (then P2, P3…) on a paper quarter and stick the notes on it.
3. Hand the parcel to the **Compute backend**. It already holds one? Wait.
4. Not enough notes? Wait. Once the Feeder says the feed is over, pack what is left.

Compute backend

You play where the jobs run, for all three transformations, and you record what each job did on the boards. One parcel at a time.

You hold: the  pads, a pen. If you get a card, read it in secret.

1. **Run:** take blank notes of the next colour, nothing to write: one green 🟩 per **SIM** parcel, one blue 🟦 per **RECO** parcel, one yellow 🟨 per **MERGE** parcel.
2. **Record:** ✓ inputs go to the board's **Done**, the new notes to its **Outputs**. A ✗ input goes back to its **Pool**.
3. Put the empty parcel in the **Bin**. A parcel is never reused.
4. When the yellow note is in Merge's Outputs and every Pool is empty, shout **“Completed!”**

Simulation board

1 red per parcel · print on A4 landscape

Pool

waiting to be packed

In: Feeder (seeds), Compute backend (✗ inputs)
Out: Packer

Done

processed by exactly one parcel

In: Compute backend only (✓ inputs)
Out: nobody

Outputs

green notes, for the next board

In: Compute backend only (new notes)
Out: the Feeder takes them to Reconstruction

Reconstruction board

2 green per parcel · print on A4 landscape

Pool

waiting to be packed

In: Feeder (green notes), Compute backend (✗ inputs)
Out: Packer

Done

processed by exactly one parcel

In: Compute backend only (✓ inputs)
Out: nobody

Outputs

blue notes, for the next board

In: Compute backend only (new notes)
Out: the Feeder takes them to Merge

Merge board

4 blue per parcel · print on A4 landscape

Pool

waiting to be packed

In: Feeder (blue notes), Compute backend (✗ inputs)
Out: Packer

Done

processed by exactly one parcel

In: Compute backend only (✓ inputs)
Out: nobody

Outputs

the yellow note: the finished product

In: Compute backend only (new notes)
The yellow note stays here: the game is over

Cards

COMPUTE BACKEND · ROUND 2 · SECRET

A job fails

Parcel `P3 · SIM` fails: make no green note and put its seed back in the Simulation Pool.

When that seed comes back on a new parcel, it works.

PACKER · ROUND 3

New Reconstruction packer

3 green  per parcel, instead of 2.

Once the Feeder says the feed is over, pack what is left.

Feeder

You play the **feeder** plugin of all three transformations, one board at a time. On Reconstruction and Merge you are an **edge feeder**: your inputs are the outputs of the board before.

You hold: the seed stack S1 … S8. Never more than **2 notes** in your hands.

1. **Simulation:** move seeds 🟥 from the stack into its Pool, **at most 2 at a time**. Stack empty? Say **“Simulation feed is over.”**
2. **Reconstruction**, once Simulation's Done holds all 8 seeds: move the green notes 🟩 from Simulation's Outputs into its Pool, at most 2 at a time. Outputs empty? Say **“Reconstruction feed is over.”**
3. **Merge**, once Reconstruction's Done holds all 8 green notes: the same with the blue notes 🟦. Then say **“Merge feed is over.”**

Packer

You play the **packer** plugin of all three transformations, one board at a time: you decide which notes go together in one job.

You hold: paper quarters, a pen. A rule may change in round 3.

1. Take notes from the Pool of the current board: **Simulation** 1 seed per parcel, **Reconstruction** 2 green, **Merge** 4 blue.
2. Write `P1 · SIM` (then P2, P3…) on a paper quarter and stick the notes on it.
3. Hand the parcel to the **Compute backend**. It already holds one? Wait.
4. Not enough notes? Wait. Once the Feeder says the feed is over, pack what is left.

Compute backend

You play where the jobs run, for all three transformations, and you record what each job did on the boards. One parcel at a time.

You hold: the  pads, a pen. If you get a card, read it in secret.

1. **Run:** take blank notes of the next colour, nothing to write: one green 🟩 per **SIM** parcel, one blue 🟦 per **RECO** parcel, one yellow 🟨 per **MERGE** parcel.
2. **Record:** ✓ inputs go to the board's **Done**, the new notes to its **Outputs**. A ✗ input goes back to its **Pool**.
3. Put the empty parcel in the **Bin**. A parcel is never reused.
4. When the yellow note is in Merge's Outputs and every Pool is empty, shout **“Completed!”**

Simulation board

1 red per parcel · print on A4 landscape

Pool

waiting to be packed

In: Feeder (seeds), Compute backend (✗ inputs)
Out: Packer

Done

processed by exactly one parcel

In: Compute backend only (✓ inputs)
Out: nobody

Outputs

green notes, for the next board

In: Compute backend only (new notes)
Out: the Feeder takes them to Reconstruction

Reconstruction board

2 green per parcel · print on A4 landscape

Pool

waiting to be packed

In: Feeder (green notes), Compute backend (✗ inputs)
Out: Packer

Done

processed by exactly one parcel

In: Compute backend only (✓ inputs)
Out: nobody

Outputs

blue notes, for the next board

In: Compute backend only (new notes)
Out: the Feeder takes them to Merge

Merge board

4 blue per parcel · print on A4 landscape

Pool

waiting to be packed

In: Feeder (blue notes), Compute backend (✗ inputs)
Out: Packer

Done

processed by exactly one parcel

In: Compute backend only (✓ inputs)
Out: nobody

Outputs

the yellow note: the finished product

In: Compute backend only (new notes)
The yellow note stays here: the game is over

Cards

COMPUTE BACKEND · ROUND 2 · SECRET

A job fails

Parcel `P3 · SIM` fails: make no green note and put its seed back in the Simulation Pool.

When that seed comes back on a new parcel, it works.

PACKER · ROUND 3

New Reconstruction packer

3 green  per parcel, instead of 2.

Once the Feeder says the feed is over, pack what is left.

Feeder

You play the **feeder** plugin of all three transformations, one board at a time. On Reconstruction and Merge you are an **edge feeder**: your inputs are the outputs of the board before.

You hold: the seed stack S1 … S8. Never more than **2 notes** in your hands.

1. **Simulation:** move seeds 🟥 from the stack into its Pool, **at most 2 at a time**. Stack empty? Say **“Simulation feed is over.”**
2. **Reconstruction**, once Simulation's Done holds all 8 seeds: move the green notes 🟩 from Simulation's Outputs into its Pool, at most 2 at a time. Outputs empty? Say **“Reconstruction feed is over.”**
3. **Merge**, once Reconstruction's Done holds all 8 green notes: the same with the blue notes 🟦. Then say **“Merge feed is over.”**

Packer

You play the **packer** plugin of all three transformations, one board at a time: you decide which notes go together in one job.

You hold: paper quarters, a pen. A rule may change in round 3.

1. Take notes from the Pool of the current board: **Simulation** 1 seed per parcel, **Reconstruction** 2 green, **Merge** 4 blue.
2. Write `P1 · SIM` (then P2, P3…) on a paper quarter and stick the notes on it.
3. Hand the parcel to the **Compute backend**. It already holds one? Wait.
4. Not enough notes? Wait. Once the Feeder says the feed is over, pack what is left.

Compute backend

You play where the jobs run, for all three transformations, and you record what each job did on the boards. One parcel at a time.

You hold: the  pads, a pen. If you get a card, read it in secret.

1. **Run:** take blank notes of the next colour, nothing to write: one green 🟩 per **SIM** parcel, one blue 🟦 per **RECO** parcel, one yellow 🟨 per **MERGE** parcel.
2. **Record:** ✓ inputs go to the board's **Done**, the new notes to its **Outputs**. A ✗ input goes back to its **Pool**.
3. Put the empty parcel in the **Bin**. A parcel is never reused.
4. When the yellow note is in Merge's Outputs and every Pool is empty, shout **“Completed!”**

Simulation board

1 red per parcel · print on A4 landscape

Pool

waiting to be packed

In: Feeder (seeds), Compute backend (✗ inputs)
Out: Packer

Done

processed by exactly one parcel

In: Compute backend only (✓ inputs)
Out: nobody

Outputs

green notes, for the next board

In: Compute backend only (new notes)
Out: the Feeder takes them to Reconstruction

Reconstruction board

2 green per parcel · print on A4 landscape

Pool

waiting to be packed

In: Feeder (green notes), Compute backend (✗ inputs)
Out: Packer

Done

processed by exactly one parcel

In: Compute backend only (✓ inputs)
Out: nobody

Outputs

blue notes, for the next board

In: Compute backend only (new notes)
Out: the Feeder takes them to Merge

Merge board

4 blue per parcel · print on A4 landscape

Pool

waiting to be packed

In: Feeder (blue notes), Compute backend (✗ inputs)
Out: Packer

Done

processed by exactly one parcel

In: Compute backend only (✓ inputs)
Out: nobody

Outputs

the yellow note: the finished product

In: Compute backend only (new notes)
The yellow note stays here: the game is over

Cards

COMPUTE BACKEND · ROUND 2 · SECRET

A job fails

Parcel `P3 · SIM` fails: make no green note and put its seed back in the Simulation Pool.

When that seed comes back on a new parcel, it works.

PACKER · ROUND 3

New Reconstruction packer

3 green  per parcel, instead of 2.

Once the Feeder says the feed is over, pack what is left.